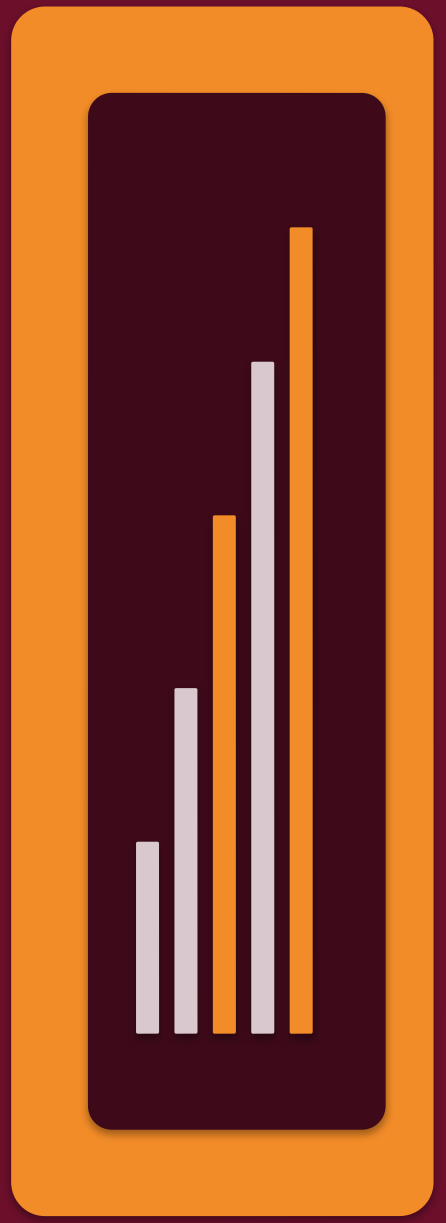
Northwind Business Performance Analysis

Turning sales and operations data into clear business priorities.

Yekini Abdulroqeeb Ademola

Data Analyst

CEO PRESENTATION • 10–15 MINUTES



02

Executive summary

The data points to a strong core business, with clear opportunities to improve visibility and control.

THE HEADLINE

$1.35M

revenue across 830 orders

The priority is not just to grow sales. It is to make performance easier to compare, protect valuable customer relationships, and investigate shipping exceptions.

01 | Revenue has clear leaders

Côte de Blaye leads product revenue; Beverages leads category revenue; the USA is the strongest market.

02 | Different measures tell different stories

Camembert Pierrot leads by units, QUICK-Stop leads customer revenue, and Save-a-lot Markets places more orders.

03 | Operations are mostly on time—with exceptions

772 orders were shipped on or before the required date; 37 were late and 21 have no recorded shipped date.

Scope: historical Northwind order data, 4 Jul 1996 – 6 May 1998. Findings are descriptive, not proof of causation or profitability.

03

Business performance at a glance

A compact baseline for the CEO before looking at products, customers, people and operations.

$1.35M
TOTAL REVENUE

830
ORDERS

$1.63K
AVERAGE ORDER VALUE

93
CUSTOMERS

77
PRODUCTS

8
CATEGORIES

DATA PERIOD

4 Jul 1996 – 6 May 1998

1996 and 1998 are partial years—compare equivalent periods, not raw annual totals alone.

04

Sales performance

Revenue changes across the available period; comparisons need to account for incomplete years.

REVENUE SIGNALS



MONTHLY VIEW

April has the highest combined revenue across the April observations in the dataset: approximately $190K.

What happened

Total revenue is approximately $1.35M across 830 orders.

Why it matters

Demand and order values vary. A peak period deserves investigation, not an assumed cause.

What to do

Track revenue, order count and average order value monthly; compare like-for-like periods.

Reporting caveat: the month chart aggregates the same calendar month across years; annual totals cover different lengths of time.

05

Product performance

Revenue, volume, category mix and inventory are complementary views—not interchangeable measures.

HIGHEST-REVENUE PRODUCT

Côte de Blaye

≈ $150K in sales

Revenue leader

HIGHEST-QUANTITY PRODUCT

Camembert Pierrot

Leads by units sold

Volume leader

TOP REVENUE CATEGORIES

1. Beverages

2. Dairy Products

Category leaders

Inventory review

Compare available stock with recent sales velocity for high-revenue and high-volume products.

The current visuals show stock on hand, but do not establish stockout risk by themselves.

Discontinued products & pricing

Eight products are flagged as discontinued. Check whether customers need suitable replacements.

Revenue alone does not prove profitability; pricing reviews need cost and margin evidence.

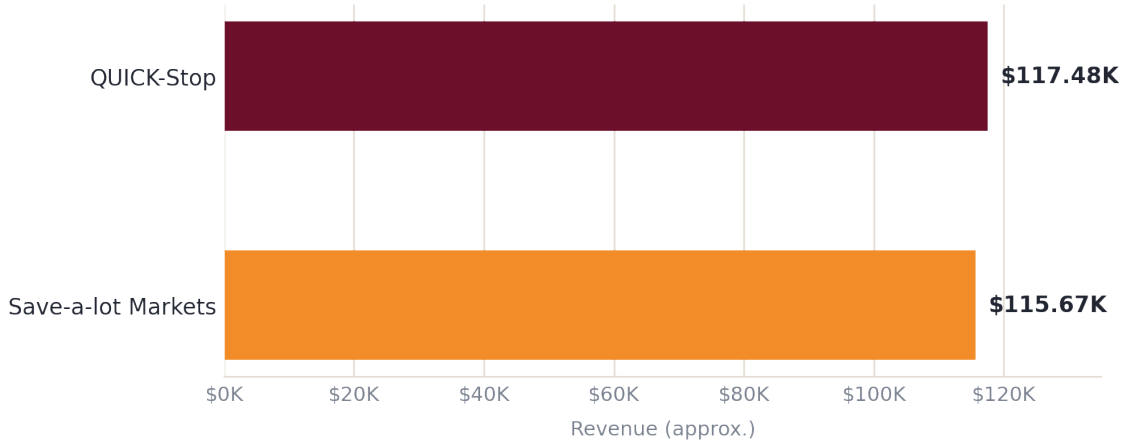
CEO takeaway: protect availability for important lines, but assess product performance using both revenue and quantity sold.

06

Customer & market performance

The strongest accounts and markets deserve attention, while lower-ranked markets should be assessed before expansion.

TOP CUSTOMER REVENUE



Save-a-lot Markets placed the most orders, even though QUICK-Stop generated slightly more revenue.

STRONGEST MARKETS

01	**USA**	Highest sales revenue
02	**Germany**	Second-highest
03	**Austria**	Third-highest

93 recorded customers

Monitor account revenue, repeat order frequency and average order value—not a single metric alone.

The figures identify leading accounts and markets; they do not by themselves prove retention risk or quantify dependence.

07

Employee & operational performance

Use balanced measures for people and distinguish shipment dispatch timing from actual delivery arrival.

EMPLOYEE-ASSOCIATED SALES

Margaret

$250.19K

18.47% of total revenue

≈156

orders handled

ROBERT

≈ $1,950

Highest average order value

Revenue alone does not prove productivity. Compare order volume, customer assignments and time period.

SHIPPING STATUS BY REQUIRED DATE



772	On/before required date	93.01%
37	Late	4.46%
21	No shipped date	2.53%

Review the 37 late records and 21 missing shipped dates. Compare carriers by freight per order and timeliness—not total freight alone.

Timing measure compares ShippedDate with RequiredDate; it is not a measure of actual delivery arrival.

08

Key business insights

Five evidence-led findings—each links what happened to why it matters.

01 Sales periods are not directly comparable

1997 is the highest annual total (~$660K), but 1996 and 1998 are partial years.

ACTION Use equivalent monthly or year-to-date comparisons before forecasting.

02 Revenue and volume identify different products

Côte de Blaye leads revenue; Camembert Pierrot leads units sold.

ACTION Monitor both leaders and align stock review to sales velocity.

03 Customer value differs from order frequency

QUICK-Stop leads revenue (~$117.48K); Save-a-lot Markets places more orders.

ACTION Track revenue, repeat frequency and average order value together.

04 Employee results depend on the metric

Margaret leads employee-associated revenue; Robert has the highest average order value.

ACTION Use balanced indicators and account for assignment and workload differences.

05 Shipping is strong but exceptions need review

772 orders are on/before required date; 37 are late and 21 lack a shipped date.

ACTION Investigate exceptions and compare carrier efficiency per order.

09

Recommendations to the CEO

A practical sequence of actions, each paired with a way to measure progress.

01	REPORTING	**Standardize monthly performance reviews.**	MEASURE Revenue, orders and average order value by equivalent periods.
02	CUSTOMERS	**Protect high-value accounts and monitor changes.**	MEASURE Account revenue, repeat order frequency and average order value.
03	OPERATIONS	**Investigate late and missing shipment records.**	MEASURE Late/missing counts, on-time proportion and freight per order.
04	PRODUCTS	**Align inventory review with sales velocity.**	MEASURE Stock on hand versus recent units sold; discontinued-item replacements.
05	WORKFORCE	**Evaluate employee-associated sales fairly.**	MEASURE Revenue, orders, average order value, customer assignments and time context.

Start with reporting and operational exceptions; these create a repeatable basis for the other reviews.

Conclusion | Turn evidence into action

Northwind has a strong foundation. The next step is more consistent management visibility.

Protect core revenue. Improve visibility. Act on exceptions.

PROTECT

Core customers and leading products

Monitor key accounts; plan stock around both revenue and volume leaders.

MEASURE

Comparable performance over time

Review monthly revenue, orders and average order value on like-for-like periods.

IMPROVE

Shipping reliability and cost control

Investigate late/missing records and compare carriers on a per-order basis.

PROPOSED NEXT STEP

Establish a monthly KPI review, a top-account review and a shipping-exception audit.

Expected value: better-informed decisions, clearer accountability and earlier visibility of business risks.